

UNION GENERAL (1828-1914)

JOSHUA LAWRENCE CHAMBERLAIN

Nobody's idea of a typical military commander, Chamberlain was an academic by profession, who was teaching modern languages at Bowdoin College, Maine when the Civil War broke out. He quickly rose to the rank of colonel in the Union army, commanding a detachment of New Englanders at the Battle of Gettysburg, where in a crucial defensive action his men held the Little Round Top hill against repeated assaults. At Petersburg, he was a brigade commander and twice wounded, once so seriously that he was initially given up for dead. Yet he recovered and was given the honor of presiding officer at the ceremonial laying down of arms by Confederate forces following Lee's surrender.

